NAME	**ANSHUL KUMAR SINGH**
ROLL NUMBER	**261450504826**
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INTERNAL ASSIGNMENT ANSWER SHEET

BUSINESS COMMUNICATION (WAC)

Assignment set – 1

Question-1:

Answer:

Communication means people sharing information so that can understand each other. Newman and Summer describe communication as an exchange of facts, ideas, opinions or emotions by two or more people. Communication is not one-way; communication is a two-way process. Feedback is essential. A message is sent by the sender. The receiver receives it. Communication succeeds when the receiver grasps it exactly as the sender intended. If meaning is lost, communication has failed. That is why listening matters a lot, as speaking. Every message must be clear. Every reaction counts. Communication is not a word; communication is a connection. Communication carries meaning. Communication relies on both speakers and listeners. Both must be involved. Otherwise, the message misses its purpose.

The Elements of the communication process:

1. **Sender/Encoder:** The person who transmits the message, for example, a manager writing a letter to a consultant.
2. **Receiver/decoder:** The person who notices the message and attaches meaning to it. Decoding may be inaccurate, so a friendly joke can be taken as an offence.
3. **Message:** any signal that triggers a response. It can be intentional, like a sales presentation, or unintentional, like a yawn showing boredom.
4. **Channel:** the medium used, such as a letter, email or telephone.
5. **Feedback:** the receiver's response, which can be oral, written or non-verbal, such as nods and smiles.
6. **Context:** the setting of the communication. It is physical (surrounding), social (relationship between the people), chronological (timing) or cultural (age, language, religion)
7. **Noise:** anything that disrupts communication. It can be physical (poor acoustics), physiological (fatigue) or psychological (fear, hostility or lack of interest).

Two barriers to communication

1. **Organizational barriers:**
   In organizations with many layers, a message passes through several levels. Each level may add to, change or lose part of the message, so it reaches the receiver distorted. Add to, change or lose part of the message, so it reaches the receiver distorted. Departmental barriers, where departments work in isolation, also fall here.
   Example: The SLM's Halley's Comet case. The Chief's memo asking staff to watch the comet, or gather in the canteen if it rained, was passed down through each level. It finally became a notice that "our chief will disappear."

Remedy: Encourage feedback, create a climate of openness where juniors can speak without fear, and use multiple channels.

2. **Linguistic and cultural barriers:**
   When the receiver cannot understand the sender's language, communication fails. The sender may use a language or speak in very technical terms. Cultural differences in values. How people see things also changes how message is understood.
   For example, Pepsi slogan "Come alive with Pepsi" was reportedly translated into Chinese as "Pepsi brings your ancestors back, from the grave!" This was a translation.
   Fix: avoid language, choose words carefully and listen actively.

In conclusion, communication goes wrong if any element of the process fails. Identifying barriers like these and acting on them at an individual and organizational level makes communication effective.

Question-2:

Answer:

There are many different ways we can communicate within an organization. Choosing the correct method will allow you to clearly deliver your messages.

Types of communication

1. **Verbal communication** uses words, whether spoken or written. Oral communication includes meetings, phone calls and presentations, such as a manager briefing a team on monthly targets. Written communication includes emails, letters, and reports, such as a bank sending a loan sanction letter. It provided a record for future references.
2. **Non-verbal communication** conveys meaning without words, through gestures, facial expressions, posture, eye contact, and tone. A candidate who sits upright and maintains eye contact in an interview appears confident.
3. **Formal communication** follows the official hierarchy and is usually documented, such as an HR circular announcing a new leave policy.
4. **Informal communication** happens outside official channels, such as colleagues discussing office matters over lunch.
5. **Communication by direction** is of three kinds. Downward flows from superiors to subordinates, such as instructions. Upward flows from subordinates to superiors, such as progress reports. Horizontal flows between peers or departments, such as sales and finance coordinating on a deal.
6. **Visual communication** uses charts, graphs, and images to make data easier to grasp, such as a sales trend graph in a board meeting.

Advantages and disadvantages of non-verbal communication

Advantages

1. It helps to support what is being said. A smile when saying hello to a customer makes the welcome feel better.
2. It can help people understand each other even when they speak a language because a nod or thumbs up is usually recognized.
3. It shows feelings and opinions and because of that it often seems more honest than words.
4. It saves time because a gesture can replace a sentence.
5. It helps to build trust and connections during meetings. When people are trying to reach an agreement.

Disadvantages

1. Gestures can easily be misunderstood. When someone has their arms crossed, it might show they are defensive. It could also just mean they are comfortable.
2. Different cultures have meanings for the same gesture. The same action might be seen as polite in one country and rude in another.
3. Things, like numbers or rules, cannot be shown with gestures. They need to be explained or written down.
4. Since gestures happen without leaving any proof, they can't be used as evidence.
5. People often make gestures without thinking about it. Someone who is nervous might accidentally show they don't feel confident.

In conclusion, each type of communication has its own role in business; non-verbal communication is powerful but works best when combined with clear verbal communication.

Question-3:

Answer:

An organization depends on ways to talk – both official and not official as well, as speaking and writing – to make sure messages get to the right people and create a good place to work. Picking the way to communicate is very important because choosing the wrong one can cause message to not get through.

Formal Communication Channels

Formal communication follows rules of an organization and is mainly used when a professional tone, difficult ideas or a lasting confirmable record are needed. Written communication is the common formal way, extremely formal and lasting, which allows people to read and look over

large amounts of detailed information whenever they want. In addition, formal communication can move from leaders down to workers. Move up and sideways between teams.

Example: Issuing a written appointment letter to a hire recording the official minutes of a board meeting, submitting a technical project report to stakeholders or sending a formal compliance document to government tax authorities. Within an office circulating a policy notice or a structured inter-office memorandum, department heads also represent formal communication.

Informal Communication Channels

Informal communication does not follow rules. It is full of surprises. It sounds like a chat. It feels personal. It is used a lot at work. It helps people get to know each other. It helps people come up with ideas. It helps people solve problems fast. People talk face to face or use phones or emails. These ways let people talk back away. These ways do not keep a paper trail.

Examples: impromptu one-on-one talks among colleagues to address a workflow bottleneck, after-hours team discussions, company outings, or a brief, informal email or instant message to a peer regarding design updates.

Classification of Channels in Practice

Business communication, both formal and informal are generally grouped into three main channel types according to interactivity and physical proximity:

1. **Two-way, face-to-face channels:** These merge verbal and non-verbal signals, providing instant feedback and a strongly individualized element. Such interactions may be formal, as in an executive board meeting or a structured performance appraisal, or informal, as in an impromptu team brainstorming session.
2. **Two-way, not face-to-face channels:** These comprise telephone calls, teleconferencing, and emails, enabled by technology when distance renders personal meetings impractical. Although they permit immediate feedback, they lack physical body language. For example, a brief phone call to verify inventory is informal, while a scheduled cross-border client teleconference is formal.
3. **One-way, not face-to-face channels:** These comprise exclusively written documents, including business letters, reports, circulars, and notices. Lacking immediate feedback and personal warmth, they function almost entirely as formal channels for official documentation and announcements.

Ultimately, effective managers combine both formal and informal channels—such as following a formal research report with an interactive presentation or a quick phone call—to ensure complete clarity and organizational alignment.

Assignment Set – 2

Question-4:

Answer:

In an organization, written communication is vital for sharing instructions, policies, and updates internally. While memos, circulars, and notices are all internal written media, they differ significantly in purpose, target audience, and distribution method.

- **Memorandum (Memo):** A memo is a note that gets passed around inside a company; it helps people talk to each other. Coworkers, bosses, or team members. It usually has a top part: who it's to who sent it the date and the subject. People use it to share decisions, make asks, or give quick updates about how things are going. It can go to one person or a whole team. It's not super formal. It's still professional. Memos are meant to be simple and easy to read.
- **Circular:** A circular constitutes a formal notice issued at the same time to a restricted group or a particular subset of individuals inside an organization. The defining feature of a circular is its direct distribution to specified recipients—frequently with signatures required as proof of receipt—instead of public posting. For instance, a manager who sends a directive solely to department heads about a budgeting meeting is employing a circular.
- **Notice:** A notice is a legal document that shares announcements, instructions or information aimed at a wide audience. Unlike circulars, which are passed hand to hand among selected people, notices are posted publicly on paper or online notice boards. Examples of notices are announcements about company holidays, safety rules, or disciplinary actions such as show-cause notices. Exact wording is very important in notices because notices can be used as evidence, in legal situations.

Formal Business Letter for a Sales Promotion

Plot 14, Commercial Complex, Sector 29, Gurugram – 122001

Tel: 0123-2888123 | E-mail: corporate@vertexoffice.in | Website: www.vertexoffice.in

Date: November 10,2026

Ref. NO: VOX/SL/2026/10

To,

Mr. Raghavendra Rao,

Administrative Head,

Sterling Financial Consultants,

MG Road, Gurugram – 122001

SUBJECT: Special promotional offer on our modular ergonomic workspace systems

Dear MR. Rao,

We are pleased to introduce our newly designed Ergonomic Executive Desking Range, created to enhance office productivity, comfort, and space efficiency in modern corporate environments.

For a limited period, we are offering an exclusive 20% promotional discount on bulk corporate orders for our valued corporate partners. This upgraded furniture line features posture-support technology, integrated cable management channels, and scratch-resistant commercial finishes, engineered specially to reduce workplace fatigue and optimize office layouts.

Because Sterling Financial Consultant is expanding its corporate footprint, we want to ensure your office interiors reflect both comfort and professional elegance. Along with the 20% price reduction, this promotional package includes complimentary on-site installation and a comprehensive 5-year structural warranty.

We would be delighted to arrange a brief walkthrough of our display center next. Tuesday to show you how these modular designs can transform your workspace.

To claim this promotional rate, please reply to this letter or contact our corporate desk before November 30,2026. We look forward to supporting your upcoming office setup.

Sincerely,

Anshul Kumar Singh

Corporate Sales Director,

Vertex Office Automation

Encl: Catalogue & Price Matrix

CC: Regional Operations Manager, Vertex Office Automation

Question-5:

Answer:

Essentials of Effective Oral Presentations

Oral business presentations serve as potent instruments when written memos or reports prove inadequate, since they capture immediate attention and permit instant feedback. Achieving a successful presentation requires attention to essential principles of structure and delivery:

- **Thorough Audience Analysis:** Before presenting, you must analyze your audience's job designations, level of knowledge, demographic characteristics, and attitude toward the topic so that technical complexity and tone can be tailored accordingly.
- **Clear Structure:** Every presentation needs to have a structure that includes:
  1. Introduction (10-15% of time): Starts with something that grabs attention (like a powerful question or a story) shows that the speaker is reliable explains exactly what the presentation is about and gives a quick look at the main topics.
  2. Holds the important information and there should be no more than five main points to keep things from getting too complicated.
  3. Conclusion (5% of time): Goes over the ideas again and ends with strong final statements or a clear request, for action.
- **Effective Delivery Style:** I find that while impromptu speaking speeches or reading from notes each have their own limits the style called "Speaking from notes" - using brief keyword cue cards - usually works best. This approach lets the speaker stay natural and maintain eye contact with the audience. Effectively Delivery Style works because it blends preparation and spontaneity.
- **Judicious Use of Visual Aids:** Visual media such as PowerPoint Slides, Charts or product demonstrations should only be used when they add value. Judicious. Use of Visual Aids means keeping slides uncluttered avoiding sentences and steering clear of garish backgrounds. PowerPoint Slides are useful when they truly enhance the message.

Key Principles of Email Etiquette

Speed and efficient make email a leading channel for external business correspondence. However, the informal nature of email demands attention to etiquette and proper formatting.

Key principles of Email Etiquette

- Watch the content: Emails create lasting records that can be forwarded or used in legal context. Therefore, I always avoid casual or offensive remarks in email.
- Manage the Tone: Without nonverbal signals, email can easily seem curt or impolite. I keep a polite tone remembering "P's" and "Q's" such as please thank you and sorry. I also avoid all-caps shouting and sarcasm in email.
- Brevity and Structure: I put information in the first three lines of email. I keep paragraphs and use the TO and CC fields carefully to protect recipient privacy.
- Promptness and Professionalism: I answer business email promptly. Proofread each email carefully for spelling and grammar, before sending.

Standard Professional Email Format

A well- structured professional email follows a clear layout:

1. **To/CC/BCC:** Primary recipients, informational copy recipients, and hidden privacy copies.
2. **Subject Line:** A brief, specific statement summarizing the core topic or action required. (e.g. Action Required: Review of Project Timeline).
3. **Salutation:** A professional greeting using the recipient's name (e.g., Dear Mr. Sharma, or Hello Team).
4. **Body Text:** A concise introduction, core details broken into short paragraphs or bullet points, and a clear call to action.
5. **Closing Statement:** A polite sign-off (e.g. King regards, or best regards,) followed by a professional signature block containing your name, title, and contact details.

Question-6:

Answer:

Type of Business Reports

Business reports are important ways to talk to people inside and outside the company. They help share facts and information so that problems can be solved and decisions can be made. These reports come in different shapes and sizes. They can be short or long. They can be sent often or not very often. They main kinds of business reports are

- **Periodic Reports:** These documents are prepared on a scheduled basis (daily weekly, monthly, or annually) and are intended solely to inform internal or external audiences. I feel that clarity is key when sharing information. Sub-categories include:
    1. Routine Management Reports: These documents give updates on sales, equipment status, and everyday operations that are shared with management and shareholders.
    2. Compliance Reports: These documents are official papers that are sent to external authorities, such, as the government to demonstrate that the company follow legal or environmental rules
    3. Progress Report: These documents give updates that describe the current status of a long-term project.
- **Proposals:** Unlike Periodic reports that only inform, the primary purpose of a proposal is to persuade. They are used internally (e.g., marketing strategy proposal) or externally (e.g., seeking government grants, pitching products to clients, or securing bank funding).
- **Policies and Procedures:** Information documents written by top management and distributed downward to all employees to communicate internal rules, guidelines, and operational procedures.

- **Situational Reports:** One-time, exceptional reports generated to address a specific, unique event or problem. Examples include market feasibility studies conducted before launching a new product or diagnostic reports investigating a sudden decline in corporate sales.

Steps Involved in Report Preparation

Because business reports drive critical management decisions, they must be carefully planned, structured, and executed. The preparation process follows five main steps:

1. **Planning the Report:**
   - First, decide what kind of report you need and clearly state the main problem that needs solving. The word "report" is the focus, and the word "problem" is the core of the work.
   - Next, split the problem into smaller manageable parts by asking the five questions: what, why, when, where and who. This will set a scope for the study and keep the report organized.
   - Finally, look at who will read this report. Identify the secondary and immediate readers. Knowing this will tell you what tone, how long, and how formal the report should be.
2. **Selecting a Method:** Choose the appropriate research methodology to gather necessary information, deciding between secondary research (utilizing books, company records, internet data) or primary research (conducting firsthand surveys or interviews).
3. **Gathering and Organizing Data:** Collect relevant information systematically and evaluate it for validating and reliability. Organize the raw data logically using summary tables, charts, or graphs to make it easy to interpret.
4. **Arriving at a Conclusion:** Objectively interpret the processed data without introducing personal bias or subjecting judgements. Draw sound, evidence-based conclusion that directly addresses the initial problem statement.
5. **Writing the Report:**
   - Set a goal to finist by a date. Make a plan that shows how the work will be organized. Begin writing the parts that're easiest to do get into a good rhythm.
   - Keep the writing clear and to the point. Using things and correct times when talking about actions.
   - Look at the version repeatedly. First, check if the plan makes sense and if the ideas are in place. Then check for mistakes, spelling, punctuation, and grammar.